CRISIS OF TERRITORIAL STATE

International system has been defined by some scholars as “any collection of independent political entities—tribes, city-state, nations, or empires—that interact with considerable frequency and according to regularized process”. However, this does not present the whole picture of the international structure. This structure is conceived as being composed of several primary actors, the states and other equally important international actors, the non-state actors. The presence of these non-state actors has a great deal of influence in developing and promoting the menu of constraints and possibilities of state actions. The international and regional inter-governmnetal organizations such as the United Nations, NATO, ASEAN, SAARC, OAU, IMF, WHO and others have come to affect the menu for choice of the states. These supranational actors have the power to act separately and make and implement decisions that are binding on members, and to some extent, non-members too. Some non-governmental organizations (NGOs) such as the Amnesty International, International Red Cross Society, several human rights bodies and environmental groups have significant influence on the policy decisions of states. With the growing interdependence of the world system individual acts also produce impact on state actions. Steady growth of world public opinion has, in many instances, influenced state policies pertaining to human rights, environment, and matters relating to war and peace.

Globalization and agents of globalization are also now restricting the sovereignty of states to such an extent that questions are being raised about the erosion of state authority. Multinational corporations, flow of capital and information technology, opening up of markets, convertibility of currencies, free trade, global stock and bond trading, and mass media are delimiting the authority of the state more and more. The present state is quite incapable of controlling phenomena such as global satellite sensing, global social and ecological problems, which might spearhead global social and ecological movements, as well as internet hacking all having great consequences on the international system.

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